

Word family: **spot / spots / spotted / spotting / spotty / spotless**

Base word: spot

Plural: spots

Past tense: spotted

Past participle: spotted

Related forms: spotty, spotless

Useful expressions / extensions: a soft spot for, on the spot, hit the spot, spot the difference, spot check, blind spot, beauty spot, spot-on

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related family (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “I quickly developed a **soft spot for him**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **spot** appears in the fixed expression:

> **have / develop a soft spot for someone**

which means:

> **to feel particular affection, fondness, or tenderness toward someone**

The speaker quickly became especially fond of Leo.

繁體中文： ** **對某人特別有好感、疼愛或偏愛；對某人有一份特別柔軟的感情

**中文翻譯： **

> “I quickly developed a soft spot for him.”

「我很快就**對他特別有好感 / 特別疼愛他**。」

Here:

develop a soft spot for someone = 漸漸對某人產生特別的喜愛和疼惜

1. **a soft spot for someone/something (特別喜愛) — 特別有好感；偏愛**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I quickly developed a **soft spot for him**.”

「我很快就**對他特別有好感**。」

Practice 2

> “My grandfather has always had a **soft spot for** animals.”

「我外公一直都**特別喜歡 / 疼愛動物**。」

Practice 3

> “She has a **soft spot for** old books.”

「她對舊書有一份**特別的喜愛**。」

****have/develop a soft spot for someone/something = 對某人 / 某物有特別的喜愛、疼惜或偏愛****

This is a fixed figurative expression.

2. ****spot = particular place/location (地點) — 地方 ; 位置****

A major everyday meaning.

Practice 4

> “This is a good **spot** for a picnic.”

「這是一個很適合野餐的**地方**。」

Practice 5

> “We found a quiet **spot** near the river.”

「我們在河邊找到一個安靜的**地方**。」

****spot = 某個具體、通常範圍較小的位置或地方****

3. ****spot = exact position (特定位置) — 位置 ; 點****

Practice 6

> “Put the chair back in the same **spot**.”

「把椅子放回原來的**位置**。」

Practice 7

> “That is the exact **spot** where we met.”

「那就是我們見面的確切**地點**。」

spot = 某個明確而具體的位置

4. **spot** = place available for someone/something (名額 / 位置) — 位子 ; 名額

A useful extension from physical position.

Practice 8

> “There is one **spot** left in the class.”

「這個課程只剩下一個**名額**。」

Practice 9

> “She earned a **spot** on the team.”

「她成功取得隊伍中的一個**席位 / 名額**。」

spot = 團隊、課程、活動等留給某人的位置或名額

5. **spot** = position in a ranking/list (排名位置) — 名次 ; 位置

Practice 10

> “The song reached the top **spot**.”

「這首歌登上**榜首**。」

Practice 11

> “The team moved into second **spot**.”

「球隊升上**第二位**。」

****spot = 排名、名單或次序中的某個位置****

6. ****spot = small mark (斑點 / 小點) — 點 ; 斑點****

Another major literal meaning.

Practice 12

> “The dog has black ****spots**** on its back.”

「那隻狗背上有黑色****斑點****。」

Practice 13

> “There was a red ****spot**** on the wall.”

「牆上有一個紅色****小點 / 斑點****。」

****spot = 表面上一小塊與周圍顏色、質地或外觀不同的痕跡****

7. ****spot = stain / dirty mark (污漬) — 污點 ; 污漬****

Practice 14

> “There is a ****spot**** of coffee on your shirt.”

「你的恤衫上有一小塊咖啡****污漬****。」

Practice 15

> “She tried to remove the ****spot**** from the carpet.”

「她嘗試清除地氈上的****污漬****。」

****spot = 衣物、家具等表面上的小污漬 / 痕跡****

8. ****spot = skin blemish/pimple (皮膚斑 / 暗瘡) — 暗瘡 ; 皮膚小斑點****

Especially common in British English.

Practice 16

> “He has a **spot** on his forehead.”

「他額頭上長了一粒**暗瘡**。」

Practice 17

> “Teenagers often worry about **spots**.”

「青少年常常會擔心臉上的**暗瘡**。」

spot = 皮膚上的小紅點、暗瘡或瑕疵；英式英語尤其常見

American English often uses:

> pimple / zit

depending on register.

9. **spot** = small amount (少量) — 一點；少許

A less central but established use.

Practice 18

> “Would you like a **spot** of tea?”

「你想喝**一點茶**嗎？」

Practice 19

> “We had a **spot** of rain in the afternoon.”

「下午下了**一點點雨**。」

a spot of something = 少量的某物 / 一點某種活動或情況

This is especially British and can sound slightly old-fashioned or playful in some contexts.

10. **spot = difficult/problematic situation (困境) — 處境 ; 麻煩**

Seen in expressions such as:

> **in a difficult/tight spot**

Practice 20

> “He found himself in a difficult **spot**.”

「他發現自己陷入一個困難的**處境**。」

Practice 21

> “Can you help me out of this tight **spot**?”

「你可以幫我擺脫這個**困境**嗎？」

spot = 某人所處的一個特定情況，尤其是困難或尷尬處境

11. **on the spot = immediately (當場 / 立即) — 當場 ; 馬上**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 22

> “She accepted the offer **on the spot**.”

「她**當場**接受了邀請。」

Practice 23

> “He was hired **on the spot**.”

「他**當場**就被聘用了。」

on the spot = 在事情發生的當下立即做某事，不延遲

12. **on the spot = at the exact place (在現場) — 在現場 ; 在事發地點**

Practice 24

> “A reporter was **on the spot** within minutes.”

「記者幾分鐘內就到達**現場**。」

Practice 25

> “Doctors treated him **on the spot**.”

「醫生在**現場**為他治理。」

on the spot = 在某件事情發生的確切地點

13. **put someone on the spot** (令某人難以即時回答) — 使尷尬；迫使即場回答

Practice 26

> “That question really **put me on the spot**.”

「那個問題真的令我**很尷尬**，不得不即場回答。」

Practice 27

> “Don’t **put her on the spot** in front of everyone.”

「不要在大家面前**迫她即場表態** / 令她難堪。」

put someone on the spot = 使某人突然面對難以回答、決定或處理的情況

14. **hit the spot** (正合需要 / 令人非常滿足) — 正合心意；正好滿足需要

A common idiom.

Practice 28

> “That hot soup really **hit the spot**.”

「那碗熱湯真的**正合我需要** / 喝得非常舒服。」

Practice 29

> “A short walk was just what I needed—it **hit the spot**.”

「短短散步正是我需要的，真的**很對胃口 / 正合需要**。」

hit the spot = 某物正好滿足當下的需要、慾望或感受

15. **spot — verb = notice / see (發現) — 看見；發現；認出**

One of the most important verb meanings.

Practice 30

> “I **spotted** Leo across the room.”

「我在房間另一邊**看見了 Leo**。」

Practice 31

> “Can you **spot** the mistake?”

「你能**找出 / 發現**那個錯誤嗎？」

spot = 在一堆事物、一定距離或不容易察覺的情況下看見、發現或認出某人 / 某物

16. **spot the difference (找不同) — 找出差異**

Practice 32

> “Can you **spot the difference** between the two pictures?”

「你能**找出兩幅圖的不同之處**嗎？」

Practice 33

> “It took me a while to **spot the difference**.”

「我花了一會兒才**看出差別**。」

spot the difference = 察覺兩個相似事物之間的不同之處

17. **spot = identify / detect (辨認 / 偵測) — 識別；察覺**

A broader extension of “notice.”

Practice 34

> “Experienced teachers can often **spot** problems early.”

「有經驗的老師通常能很早便**察覺問題**。」

Practice 35

> “The software can **spot** unusual patterns.”

「這套軟件可以**偵測出**異常模式。」

spot = 從跡象、模式或大量資訊中辨認出某個目標 / 問題

18. **spot someone** = recognize someone (認出某人) — 認出

Practice 36

> “She **spotted** an old friend in the crowd.”

「她在人群中**認出了一位老朋友**。」

Practice 37

> “I **spotted** him immediately.”

「我立即就**認出他**。」

spot someone = 在人群或一定距離中看見並辨認出某人

19. **spot** = mark/stain something (弄上斑點) — 弄髒 ; 留下斑點

A less frequent verb sense.

Practice 38

> “Mud **spotted** his trousers.”

「泥濘在他的褲子上留下了**污點**。」

Practice 39

> “The rain **spotted** the window.”

「雨水在窗上留下了**點點痕跡**。」

spot something = 在某物表面留下小斑點、污漬或痕跡

20. **spotted** = covered/marked with spots (有斑點的) — 有斑點的

Practice 40

> “We saw a **spotted** dog.”

「我們看到一隻**有斑點的狗**。」

Practice 41

> “The bird has a **spotted** chest.”

「那隻鳥的胸部有**斑點花紋**。」

spotted = 表面帶有多個小斑點 / 花紋的

21. **spotty** = covered with spots (有很多斑點的) — 斑斑點點的

Practice 42

> “The horse has a **spotty** coat.”

「那匹馬的毛皮**斑斑點點**。」

Practice 43

> “He wore a **spotty** shirt.”

「他穿了一件**有圓點圖案的恤衫**。」

spotty = 布滿斑點、圓點或小點的

Especially common in British English.

22. **spotty = inconsistent / uneven (不穩定的) — 時好時壞的 ; 不一致的**

A useful figurative meaning.

Practice 44

> “The internet connection is **spotty**.”

「網絡連線**時好時壞 / 不穩定**。」

Practice 45

> “Her attendance has been **spotty** this term.”

「她這學期的出席情況一直**斷斷續續、不太穩定**。」

spotty = 品質、表現、覆蓋或出現情況不平均、不穩定或斷斷續續的

This is especially common in American English.

23. **spotless = completely clean (毫無污漬的) — 一塵不染的 ; 非常乾淨的**

Practice 46

> “The kitchen was **spotless**.”

「廚房**一塵不染**。」

Practice 47

> “She keeps the house **spotless**.”

「她把房子保持得**非常乾淨**。」

spotless = 完全沒有污點、污漬或髒污的

24. **spotless = without fault / wrongdoing (毫無瑕疵的) — 清白的 ; 無可挑剔的**

A figurative extension.

Practice 48

> “He has a **spotless** record.”

「他的紀錄**完全清白 / 毫無污點**。」

Practice 49

> “The company wants to maintain a **spotless** reputation.”

「公司希望保持**毫無瑕疵的聲譽**。」

spotless = 沒有錯誤、污點、不當行為或負面紀錄的

25. **blind spot** (盲點) — 視線死角；認知盲點

A major compound.

Practice 50

> “The cyclist was in the driver’s **blind spot**.”

「單車手正處於司機的**視線盲點**。」

Practice 51

> “We all have emotional **blind spots**.”

「我們每個人都有一些情感上的**認知盲點**。」

blind spot = 無法看見的區域；亦比喻某人沒有察覺、理解或承認的弱點 / 問題

26. **beauty spot** (美景地點 / 美人痣) — 風景名勝；美人痣

A particularly interesting polysemous compound.

Practice 52

> “The lake is a famous local **beauty spot**.”

「這個湖是本地著名的**風景名勝**。」

Practice 53

> “She has a small **beauty spot** near her mouth.”

「她嘴邊有一顆小小的**美人痣**。」

beauty spot = 美麗的景點；亦可指被視為有特色的面部小痣

The exact sense is context-dependent.

27. **spot check** (抽查) — 隨機檢查；抽查

Practice 54

> “The manager carried out a **spot check**.”

「經理進行了一次**抽查**。」

Practice 55

> “Police conduct regular **spot checks**.”

「警方定期進行**隨機抽查**。」

spot check = 沒有全面檢查所有項目，而是臨時 / 隨機挑選部分進行檢查

28. **spot-on** = exactly correct (完全準確的) — 完全正確；非常準確

A common informal compound.

Practice 56

> “Your description is **spot-on**.”

「你的描述**非常準確 / 完全正確**。」

Practice 57

> “His prediction was **spot-on**.”

「他的預測**完全準確**。」

****spot-on = 非常準確、恰到好處或完全正確的****

Register:

> informal, especially common in British English

Important distinction: **spot vs place**

Both can mean 「地方」.

**place**

is very broad:

> any location, area, building, position, etc.

**spot**

usually suggests:

> a smaller or more specific location.

> “a nice place to visit”

= 一個值得去的地方

> “a nice spot for a picnic”

= 一個適合野餐的具體地點

Important distinction: **spot vs point**

**spot**

usually refers to an identifiable physical location.

**point**

can be:

* a precise location

- * a stage
- * an idea
- * a numerical position

> “at this point in the road”

is more abstract/precise than:

> “at this spot.”

Important distinction: **spot vs mark**

spot

often means:

> a small roundish area differing from its surroundings.

mark

is broader:

> any visible sign, line, stain, scratch, etc.

Every spot can be a mark, but not every mark is a spot.

Important distinction: **spot vs stain**

spot

may simply be a small coloured mark.

stain

specifically suggests:

> discoloration caused by something dirty/liquid/etc., often difficult to remove.

> “a red spot”

need not be dirty.

> “a coffee stain”

specifically comes from coffee.

Important distinction: **spot vs pimple**

spot

in British English often means:

> pimple / acne blemish.

pimple

is more anatomically specific and is widely understood across varieties.

So:

> “I’ve got a spot.”

in BrE can mean:

> 「我長了一粒暗瘡。」

Important distinction: **spot vs notice**

notice

= become aware of something.

spot

often emphasizes:

> successfully seeing or identifying something that is not immediately obvious.

> “I noticed the sign.”

= 我留意到那個標誌。

> “I spotted him in the crowd.”

= 我在人群中認出了他。

So **spot** can imply a small act of detection.

Important distinction: **spot vs find**

spot

= see/identify something.

find

= successfully locate or discover it.

You can:

> spot your keys across the room

without needing to search for them.

But:

> find your keys

may involve searching.

Important distinction: **a soft spot vs liking**

liking

= general positive feeling.

a soft spot

= a particularly tender, affectionate, sometimes slightly biased fondness.

> “I like him.”

is neutral.

> “I have a soft spot for him.”

suggests:

> 「我對他特別心軟 / 特別疼愛。」

So your passage uses a warmer, more emotionally specific expression than simple **like**.

Important distinction: **soft spot vs **weak spot****

These look similar but differ significantly.

**soft spot for someone**

= affection / fondness.

**weak spot**

= vulnerability / area of weakness.

> “I have a soft spot for children.”

= 我特別喜歡小朋友。

> “Maths is my weak spot.”

= 數學是我的弱項。

Important distinction: **on the spot — place vs immediately**

Place:

> “Doctors treated him on the spot.”

= 醫生在現場治理他。

Immediately:

> “She agreed on the spot.”

= 她當場立即答應。

Same expression, different contextual emphasis.

Important distinction: ****spotty — spotted vs inconsistent****

Physical:

> “a spotty shirt”

= 有圓點圖案的恤衫

Figurative:

> “spotty internet service”

= 時好時壞的網絡服務

The figurative sense comes from the idea of:

> coverage appearing in patches rather than continuously.

Important distinction: ****spotless — physical vs figurative****

Physical:

> “a spotless kitchen”

= 一塵不染的廚房

Figurative:

> “a spotless reputation”

= 毫無污點的聲譽

The figurative branch maps:

> physical stain → moral/reputational stain.

Important distinction: ****spot — noun vs spot — verb****

Noun:

> “That is a nice spot.”

= 那是一個很好的地方。

Verb:

> “I spotted him.”

= 我看見 / 認出他。

This POS shift produces a major learner-relevant meaning change.

Family-extension note

****Spot**** is a strong polysemy candidate because it has several genuinely distinct modern semantic centres:

- * ****specific place**** = 地點 / 位置
- * ****available/ranked position**** = 名額 / 名次
- * ****small mark**** = 斑點
- * ****stain**** = 污漬
- * ****skin blemish**** = 暗瘡
- * ****small amount**** = 少許
- * ****situation**** = 處境
- * ****verb: detect/notice**** = 發現 / 認出
- * ****verb: mark with spots**** = 留下斑點

Then there are highly useful lexicalized expressions and compounds:

- * ****a soft spot for****
- * ****on the spot****
- * ****put someone on the spot****
- * ****hit the spot****
- * ****blind spot****
- * ****beauty spot****
- * ****spot check****
- * ****spot-on****
- * ****spotty****
- * ****spotless****

The important curation point is not to split every physical-location or mark collocation independently. The manual asks us to sweep broadly but merge uses that share the same semantic concept.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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a soft spot for	對某人 / 某物有特別的喜愛、疼惜或偏愛
spot — place	某個具體、通常範圍較小的位置或地方
spot — exact position	某個明確而具體的位置
spot — available place	課程、團隊、活動等留給某人的名額 / 位置
spot — ranking	排名、名單或次序中的某個位置
spot — mark	表面上一小塊與周圍顏色 / 外觀不同的斑點
spot — stain	表面上的小污漬或髒痕
spot — skin	皮膚上的暗瘡、小紅點或瑕疵
a spot of something	少量的某物；一點
spot — situation	某人所處的特定情況，尤其指困難處境
on the spot — location	在事情發生的確切現場
on the spot — immediately	當場立即做某事
put someone on the spot	迫使某人即時回答 / 決定而令其感到為難
hit the spot	正好滿足當下需要、慾望或感受
spot — notice	在不容易察覺的情況下看見、發現或認出
spot — detect	從跡象、模式或資訊中辨認出目標 / 問題
spot — mark/stain verb	在某物表面留下斑點或污漬
spotted	表面帶有多個斑點或花紋的
spotty — physical	布滿斑點或小圓點的
spotty — figurative	品質、表現或覆蓋不穩定、斷斷續續的
spotless — physical	完全沒有污點或髒污的；一塵不染
spotless — figurative	沒有錯誤、不當行為或負面紀錄的
blind spot	無法看見的區域；亦指自己未察覺的弱點 / 問題
beauty spot	美麗景點；亦可指面部美人痣
spot check	臨時 / 隨機抽取部分項目進行檢查
spot-on	非常準確、恰到好處或完全正確

For your original sentence

> “He was full of energy, but at the same time he was warm, funny, and surprisingly thoughtful, so I quickly developed **a soft spot for him**.”

The exact meaning is:

a soft spot for someone = 對某人有一份特別溫柔、疼愛和偏愛的感情

Therefore:

> **developed a soft spot for him**

= **「很快便開始特別喜歡他 / 對他產生了一份特別的疼愛」**

It is stronger and warmer than simply:

> **I liked him.**

The image behind the idiom is figurative:

> a normally firm emotional attitude has a **“soft” place** when it comes to that person.

So **spot** here does **not** mean:

* 地點

* 斑點

* 暗瘡

* 名額

* 發現

It belongs to the established idiom:

> **have / develop a soft spot for someone**.